

# Where do **my cells** sit?

A habit worth having, and **the loop that pays for it.**

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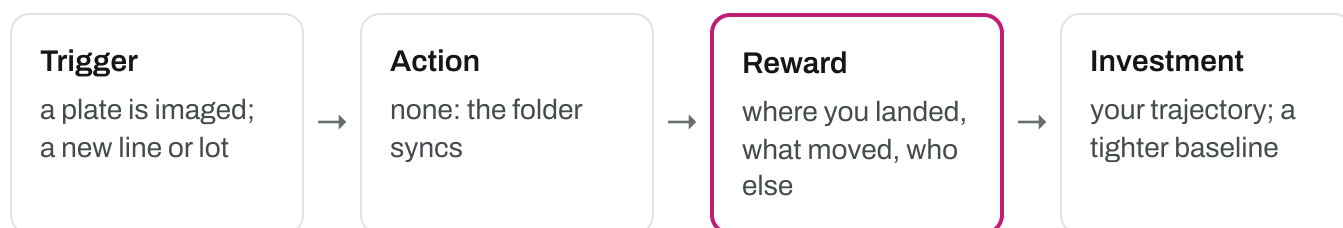
## Vision

Every lab running a cell line should know, every time it images a plate, where its cells sit among everyone else's, and what to do if they have moved. The model is Strava's segments: your run placed among everyone who ran the same stretch of road. Here the road is the cell line, and the field is every lab that ran it.

The product earns its habit the way a bathroom scale or a credit score does: the number is about you, it changes, and nobody knows it until they look. It never earns it the way a feed does. Everything below serves one rule: **uploading must be effortless, and the answer must be worth looking at.**

## 01 The habit loop

**Fig. 1** Every upload makes the next answer worth opening



↻ back to Trigger: the reference grows, the next reading is sharper

| STEP       | IN DATUM LINE                                              | DESIGN RULE                                                   |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Trigger    | the microscope finishes a plate; a new line or lot arrives | the trigger is the instrument, not an email                   |
| Action     | nothing: the export folder syncs                           | any click is a leak; the reference starves on friction        |
| Reward     | where you landed, which features moved, who else moved     | real uncertainty: nobody knows their position until they look |
| Investment | your history becomes a trajectory; your baseline tightens  | leaving costs your own past, which is honest switching cost   |

## 02 Six magic moments

Each moment turns an image the lab already has into something it could not see before, and each is ordered by when a new customer meets it.

| # | MOMENT                                        | WHAT THE LAB SEES                                                                                                  | WHEN                 |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1 | <b>Your past, diagnosed</b>                   | old plates dragged in on day one appear as a path across the field map: "you left the envelope in March"           | first ten minutes    |
| 2 | <b>Show the cells, not the score</b>          | when a plate moves, its nuclei next to their nearest neighbours from labs in distribution: same size, more texture | every flag           |
| 3 | <b>The fix</b>                                | what the in-distribution labs do differently: seeding density, media or serum lot                                  | after a flag         |
| 4 | <b>A forecast</b>                             | "at your current drift, this line leaves the envelope in about five weeks"                                         | after three readings |
| 5 | <b>Someone else's plate saves your screen</b> | a lot you use is drifting at other labs, before your own plates show it                                            | once labs share lots |

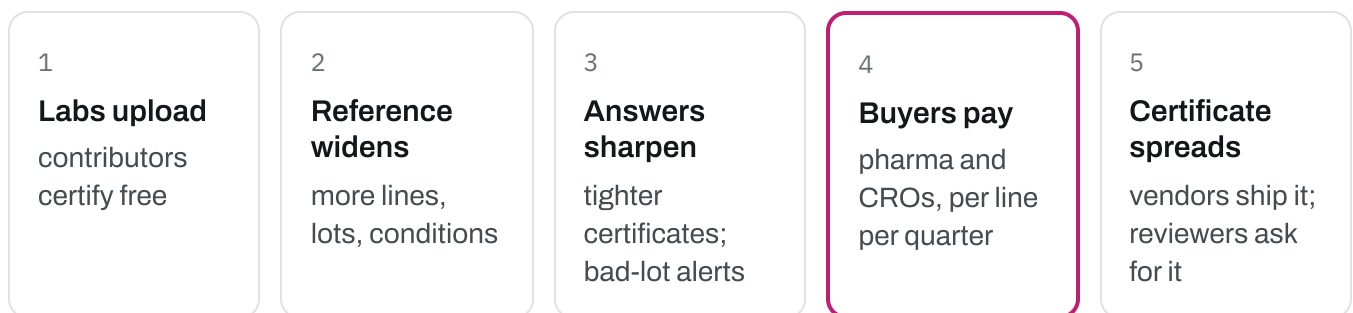
| # | MOMENT                             | WHAT THE LAB SEES                                                      | WHEN                       |
|---|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 6 | <b>The certificate as currency</b> | a verifiable link for a methods section, a CRO handoff, a grant report | when results leave the lab |

Moments 1 to 4 work for a single lab on day one, against the public reference. Moments 5 and 6 exist only once the network does, and no competitor can copy them without the labs.

### 03 The revenue loop

**The real product is the standard:** one map every lab's cells are placed on, and the benchmark every method is graded against. It has three layers. **Community**, open: the map, the box, the code, the public reference, labs by number, streaks and ranks; it stays fully usable for free, forever, or the standard dies. **Data access**, paid: the same data structured, comparable, pre-cleaned on request, with provenance and the certificate attached; the API, not the website. **The benchmark**, co-built: industry partners contribute failures and get their methods graded, segmentation to bioactivity, so the labs that make data and the companies that buy it grade against one set.

**Fig. 2 Free uploads build the reference that paid certificates sell**



↺ 5 brings more labs to 1; revenue funds bench time and people

The habit loop feeds the revenue loop. Free contributors widen the reference; a wider reference sharpens every certificate and makes bad-lot alerts possible; sharper answers are what pharma and CROs pay for; paid and shared certificates spread through vendors and reviewers, which brings more labs in.

| BUYER                    | PAYS FOR                                | PROPOSED PRICE                                                  | WHY THEY KEEP PAYING                                                 |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Academic labs and cores  | nothing, if they contribute             | free for contributors, \~\$500–1,000 per line-quarter otherwise | their own trajectory and the diagnosis of their past                 |
| Pharma and CRO screening | certificates, forecasts, the fix        | \~\$5–15k per line-quarter, or a site license                   | one late-caught line cost \~\$2.6M; a quarterly reading is insurance |
| Cell banks and vendors   | a lot certificate to ship with each lot | per lot                                                         | customers start asking for it                                        |
| Everyone, later          | bad-lot alerts                          | subscription                                                    | only the network can produce them                                    |

The quarter is a starting cadence: in the one lab measured, a baseline is stale within weeks. Pricing is proposed, not validated; the roadmap doc carries the anchors.

**Who pays, exactly.** The buyer of cell data it did not make: an AI-bio company or a pharma paying a CRO for a screen. The CRO uploads for free because its customer asks for the certificate; the customer pays per certificate on the data it bought. Labs that only ever upload still get the map, the certificate and the game, and every one of them makes the map denser for the paying side.

## 04 A healthy habit, not a trap

The product dies the day a lab hides its worst plate, because the worst plates teach the field most. Every design choice protects honest uploads.

| DO                                                           | DON ' T                            | WHY                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Show each lab its position privately; publish only the field | public leaderboards of labs        | shame makes labs withhold bad plates, which poisons the reference |
| Give credit for uploading flagged plates                     | penalise being out of distribution | failures are the most valuable data                               |
| Keep a record of certified quarters                          | "don't break your streak" nudges   | a streak rewards hiding the plate that would break it             |

| DO                                                | DON ' T                              | WHY                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Explain every flag with cells and a suggested fix | a bare red dot                       | a verdict without a reason feels like judgement, not help |
| Let the instrument trigger uploads                | notifications to come back and check | the reward is the answer, not the visit                   |

## 05 The end state: from loved to required

The strongest habit is one an institution asks for. Identity testing got there when journals and funders began asking labs to show their cells were what they claimed. A behaviour certificate can follow the same path: first reviewers ask for it, then CRO contracts include it, then a vendor lot ships with it by default.

That lock-in has a cost: a required certificate reads as compliance, and compliance is rarely loved. So the order matters. Build the loved product first (the map, the cells, the fix, the warning) so that when it becomes required, labs already want it.

## 06 Metrics

**North star: the share of a customer's plates that upload with no human action.** If it is high, the loop turns; if people have to remember, nothing else matters.

| METRIC                               | WHAT IT TELLS YOU                     | LOOP    |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------|
| Automatic upload share               | the habit exists without effort       | habit   |
| Flagged plates uploaded, not deleted | labs trust the product with bad news  | honesty |
| Time from upload to first look       | the answer is worth opening           | reward  |
| Lines per lab, labs per line         | the reference is widening             | network |
| Labs sharing a lot                   | bad-lot alerts are possible           | network |
| Paid line-quarters, renewal rate     | the certificate is worth money, again | revenue |

| METRIC                             | WHAT IT TELLS YOU                   | LOOP   |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------|
| Certificates cited outside the lab | the certificate has become currency | spread |

## The game

Every batch a lab sends is ranked against every batch the field has seen, on its untreated wells alone: how typical the cells are, how alike the plates are, how steady the lab is from batch to batch, and cells per well against the field. Nothing in the score touches a treated well or a result, so the only way to climb is better culture and imaging practice. A lab sees its rank, its personal best, its streak of batches in distribution, the one measure that would move it up most, and the lab to beat. On the public data one lab holds 9 of the top ten and a streak of 33 (results/e14). Segments are per cell line; a quarter is a season; badges are for the centre, the tightest plates and the longest streak. Names on the board are the lab's choice: a lab can compete in public or watch in private.